DIVYA'S PREGNANCY Journey

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DIVYA'S PREGNANCY WELLNESS GUIDE

Welcome to the 2nd trimester! Your baby hears your heartbeat by week 18 and will hear your voice, too. Little fingerprints and footprints are forming and so is hair. Your baby's digestive system will start to function and produce and release urine, which becomes amniotic fluid. Your baby's nervous system develops and they will be able to feel all your movements.

Name DIVYA MEHROTRA		**Date** MAR 19 2026	
Location	**NOIDA**	**Age**	**33**
Week of Pregnancy	**16 WEEKS**	**Trimester**	**SECOND**

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Lifestyle Recommendations by Dr Rajeshwari Bangera

- **Growing Belly**: Don't stand for long periods, Sit straight, use a firm mattress, lie on your side with a pillow between your legs
- **Stiffness and aches**: Walk 30 mins daily. 3-5 times a week, do Yoga for 45 Mins, everyday. Practise mindfulness while sitting in the morning sunlight for Vitamin D.
- **Anxiety and Stress**: Do breathing exercises daily, meditate and listen to calming music, do Sheetali Pranayama.
- **Urinary Tract Infection**: The cramps will be accompanied by painful urination, the frequent need to pee, and lower abdominal discomfort.
- **Heartburn**: Use a pillow of 6 inch thickness, have 2 tsps of Apple Cider Vinegar in warm water on empty stomach, sleep 3 hours after dinner, have a banana, do Malasana, have warm water with ushir (vetiver root).

Sleep:

- Lie on left side to keep blood circulation on for the baby
- Try to take a nap if you feel drowsy during the day. Yoga nidra.
- Head massage with any medicated oil along with massage on the ears.
- Practice relaxation techniques before going to bed like pressing on toes and soles of the feet.

Stress:

- Avoid horror movies and intense music
- Surround yourself with positive energy/ people
- Listening to hymns and soothing music helps to create a positive vibration.
- Sit in any comfortable posture and close your eyes. Inhale deeply and exhale chanting three times .

- Avoid heavy/ crowded places

Activity:

- Listen to imumz music collection and devotional songs in morning and evening.
- Playing some indoor games like carroms, chess etc.
- Gardening, painting, reading books, singing or any of the favourite hobbies
- Going out to a park or beach on weekends.
- Walk on an even surface with comfortable footwear.
- **Start walking**. Begin with 10 minutes and slowly, increase to 30 mins.Use supportive footwear for extra grip.
- **Begin breathing exercises**. Lie down, inhale, fill lungs fully, count 8 and exhale. 5 times a day, thrice a day. Also, Sukhasana breathing. Sit in Sukhasana, Inhale deeply and exhale for 5 counts. Then, move in a gentle rocking motion along with your breath.
- **Do stretching** exercises for 10 minutes before sleeping.

- **Others :** Wake up in the early morning and feel the fresh air outside. (outdoor time)
  Exposure to sunlight in the morning daily.
- **Get dental issues checked before they worsen**. Brush twice a day and floss at least once, avoid junk food and sweets, do daily oil pulling with sunflower oil or sesame oil, add Amla to your diet.

Lifestyle Don’ts

- Don’t do Bellow’s breath (bhastrika), Cleaning breath (kapalabhati).
- Avoid sour, salty, bitter, oily, spicy, and fried foods and tea, coffee, that has aggravated the Pitta (fire) in your body.
- Don’t wax or bleach your face: If you wax your brows or upper lip, try avoiding it during pregnancy. Don’t take medications without consulting your doctor
- Don’t lie on your back for a long time.
- Don’t wear high heels.

Symptom Specific Recommendations by Dr Rajeshwari Bangera

Sleeping Postures in Pregnancy

✅ **Best Position**

Left lateral position (left side lying)

- Improves blood flow to the uterus and placenta
- Reduces pressure on liver and major blood vessels
- Helps digestion and prevents acidity

How to support the body

- Pillow between knees
- Small pillow under abdomen

- Light support behind the back to prevent rolling

Sitting Posture (At home or work)

✅ **Ideal Sitting**

- Sit with **spine upright but relaxed**
- Feet flat on the ground or on a small stool
- Lower back supported with a cushion

✔️ **Helpful habits**

- Change position every 30–45 minutes
- Gentle ankle rotations while seated

Walking Posture

✅ **Correct Way to Walk**

- Walk slowly and rhythmically
- Head balanced, shoulders relaxed
- Arms swinging naturally
- Abdomen relaxed, not pulled in
- Short, steady steps
- **Stretch calf muscles before sleeping.**

Lifestyle & Dietary Management

Eating habits

- Eat small, frequent meals every 2–3 hours
- Avoid an empty stomach (keep dry snacks like biscuits ready)
- Have a light snack before getting out of bed

Avoid triggers

- Spicy, oily, fried, or strong-smelling foods

Hydration

- Sip fluids throughout the day.
- Try coconut water, lemon water, buttermilk

Rest & environment

- Get adequate rest
- Avoid strong smells, perfumes, kitchen fumes
- Fresh air and light walking can help

Natural / Home Remedies

- Ginger: ginger tea, small ginger pieces, or ginger candy
- Lemon: lemon water or just smelling lemon can reduce nausea

- Mint: mint tea or leaves may soothe the stomach
- Jeera water (cumin water)
- Elaichi (cardamom) chewing helps reduce nausea

Management of headaches:

Lifestyle & General Measures (First-line)

Rest & sleep

- Maintain a regular sleep schedule
- Take short daytime rest if needed

Hydration

- Drink plenty of fluids (2.5–3 liters/day)
- Dehydration is a very common trigger

Diet

- Eat small, frequent meals to avoid low blood sugar
- Don’t skip meals

Posture

- Maintain good posture, especially while sitting or feeding baby
- Use proper pillows for neck support

Identify & Avoid Triggers

Common triggers include:

- Stress and anxiety
- Bright lights / loud noise
- Strong smells

Simple Home Remedies

- Cold compress on forehead
- Warm compress on neck/shoulders
- Gentle head and neck massage
- Rest in a dark, quiet room

Relaxation Techniques

- Deep breathing exercises
- Prenatal yoga
- Meditation

FOOT MASSAGE :

How to Do Foot Massage Safely

Position

- Sit comfortably with legs slightly elevated

Technique

- Use gentle, slow strokes
- Start from toes → move towards heel → then ankle
- Light circular motions on the sole
- Gentle squeezing of toes and arch

Duration

- 10–15 minutes per foot is enough

Oils You Can Use

- Coconut oil
- Almond oil
- Sesame oil

Interesting Videos Related to Trimester 2	
Mudras for healthy pregnancy	http://youtube.com/watch?v=zVnEcTJ7CgY
Yoga poses to avoid	http://youtube.com/watch?v=aC9Q6XRT3eY
Thyroid during pregnancy	http://youtube.com/watch?v=_9ONH5ncrDo
Deworming in pregnancy	http://youtube.com/watch?v=0DAYdKDHjFk
Managing Summer season	http://youtube.com/watch?v=oUl4BAN4mIQ
What should I eat in the 2nd trimester	http://youtube.com/shorts/fF3Bo4hqKcI
Garbh Samvad	http://youtube.com/watch?v=gX5NAi_g-IE
Gestational diabetes tips	http://youtube.com/watch?v=EAPOszWSbzY

Daddy's role

1. **Plan a holiday:** This is the golden period when mum feels better. Take a holiday and discuss about the future that is coming.
2. **Manage her food cravings**: Her appetite has now opened up and she might crave a lot of different things, including junk. Help her get healthy replacements for those. Keep an eye on her weight-gain.
3. **Talk to the baby:** Daddy's voice has been proven to give the baby assurance that all is well and that (s)he is welcome.
4. **Address the tough topics**: Start a conversation about finances, expectations about household tasks, and role of other family members as your lives change forever.

5. **Show affection:** Hold hands and give hugs. It's not enough to say you love her, at this point, she needs more demonstration now than ever.

Scans and Tests in 2nd Trimester	
Routine Test	**15 and 20** • Routine examination of woman, weight, and BP, fundal height.
Anomaly Scan abdominal scan (Offered on the same day as routine test)	**18-23 weeks** • Head circumference (HC). • Abdominal circumference (AC). • The femur or thigh bone (FL). • Humerus or the long arm bone. • Study of baby's brain, face, spine, heart, stomach, bowel, kidneys, limbs and gestational age. • Level of amniotic fluid. • Position of the placenta.

Oral Glucose Tolerance Test OGTT Random blood sugar test is done for every patient from 28 weeks. If the random tests shows high readings, the OGTT is done.	**24 -28 weeks** • Fast overnight (8-12) hours. The 1st blood sample is collected in a fasting state. • Then **75 gm** glucose powder mixed in 200 ml of water is given to drink. *Not less than 75 gms, please note!* • Blood sample is collected again after 1 hour and at 2 hours. **Results:** Fasting - 92 mg/dL (5.1 mmol/L) At 1 hour - 180 mg/dL (10.0 mmol/L) At 2 hour- 153 mg/dL (8.5 mmol/L) **Precautions** Don't eat anything during the fasting period. If you vomit the sugary solution within ½ hour of ingestion, the test will be done another day. **Want to learn more?** Here is a link: https://www.imumz.com/post/gestational-diabetes-signs-and-symptoms-causes-diet-treatment
Quadruple Marker Test Offered only in high risk, patients above 35 and/or something unusual has been observed in the anomaly scan. It checks 4 markers: • Alpha-fetoprotein (AFP): A protein produced by the baby's liver and other organs. • Unconjugated estriol (UE): A protein produced	**18-23 weeks** It is usually offered to women: • Over the age of 35 years or more. • Having a family history of genetic defects. • Suffering from diabetes and use insulin. • Have been through high levels of radiation therapy before. • Suffering from viral infection during pregnancy.

in the placenta and in the baby's liver. • Human chorionic gonadotropin (hCG): A hormone produced by the placenta. • Inhibin-A: a hormone produced by the placenta	
Tetanus Shot Offered to all.	**Tetanus Shot 1: 18 weeks** **Tetanus Shot 2: 24 Weeks or T-DAP is given at 32 weeks** It is completely safe though you may experience slight fever and rashes as side-effects.
COVID Booster	It is take to take one booster shot during the pregnancy - in the 2nd or 3rd trimester.
Flu Shot	If the patient has a susceptibility to flu or the patient lives in a city/neighbourhood where infections spread a lot, this is advised.